Case study 1: Bedside cabinet

National 5 · Practical Woodworking · Answers and marking guidance

Award one mark per correct point unless stated. Other valid answers should be credited. Sketches can gain full marks if they show enough detail.

1 (a) State one advantage of using a stopped housing rather than a through housing. (1 mark)

- The joint is hidden from the front, so it looks neater

1 (b) Describe the stages in marking out and cutting the stopped housing. Your answer can include sketches. (3 marks)

- Mark the shelf position/width across the side with a try square and marking knife; gauge the depth and stop
- Chop a recess at the stopped end with a chisel, then saw down both sides with a tenon saw
- Remove waste with a chisel and level the bottom with a hand router; notch the shelf to fit

2 (a) Describe how plywood is made. (1 mark)

- Thin layers (veneers) glued together with the grain of each layer at 90° to the next

2 (b) State one advantage of plywood for the back panel. (1 mark)

- Strong in all directions / won't split
- Stable: won't warp
- Available in large thin sheets

Any 1 point.

3 Describe two advantages of using knock-down fittings for this cabinet. (2 marks)

- Can be flat-packed so it is cheaper/easier to transport and store
- Customer can assemble it quickly with simple tools
- Can be taken apart to move house

Any 2 points.

4 Name a suitable finish and describe how it is applied. (2 marks)

- Danish oil / clear varnish / wax
- Apply with a lint-free cloth or brush, with the grain, in thin coats, rubbing down lightly between coats

Total: 10 marks